

Riccardo Carlesso - CV

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Staff Developer Advocate (L6) | Agentic AI & SRE Specialist | Cloud Architect | University Lecturer

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Executive Summary

Staff Developer Advocate, Principal Cloud Architect, and AI Agentic Systems Engineer with over 20 years of experience in distributed operations, cloud infrastructure, and software engineering. Recognized industry authority in **Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)**, **Generative AI & Autonomous Agentic Systems (Gemini, Model Context Protocol, Multi-Agent Harnesses)**, **DevOps/CI-CD**, and **Enterprise Cloud Adoption**.

Global co-creator and co-owner of Google's flagship **"The Art of SLOs"** curriculum ([official video](#)). Author of open-source AI agent frameworks ([antigravity-ruby-sdk](#) with Policy Engine DSL, [sre-extension](#)). University Lecturer at **Hochschule Luzern (HSLU)** teaching two postgraduate CAS cloud computing courses. Proven track record leading cloud architectures for major EMEA enterprises (Lufthansa, Deutsche Bank, SAP) and shaping Google Cloud products. Two-time full Ironman triathlete and classical pianist.

Core Competencies & AI Specializations

- **Generative & Agentic AI:** Autonomous Agentic Harnesses, Multi-Agent Orchestration, Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers & clients, Google Agent Development Kit (ADK), Gemini API (Gemini 2.5/3 Pro & Flash, Multimodal Vision, Audio/TTS, Veo video generation, Imagen 3, Lyria 3 music), RAG architectures, LangChain & `langchain.rb`, Dynamic Policy Engine DSL & Security Guardrails.
- **Core SRE & Cloud Architecture:** Site Reliability Engineering (SRE), Service Level Objectives (SLOs) & Error Budgets, Incident Management & Automated Postmortems, Enterprise Landing Zones, Hybrid Cloud Networking, DevOps/DevSecOps, CI/CD.

- **Cloud Platforms & Infrastructure:** Google Cloud Platform (Compute Engine, Cloud Run, GKE, Cloud Deploy, Cloud Build, Vertex AI, BigQuery, IAM, VPC), Bare-metal & Virtualization (KVM, Xen, Ganeti, OpenStack).
 - **Programming Languages:** **Ruby** (advanced / gem author), **Bash** (expert wizard), **Python** (fluent), **Go**, **SQL** (BigQuery/Dremel, PostgreSQL, MySQL), C/C++, Perl, PHP.
 - **Tools & Frameworks:** Ruby on Rails, Pulumi, Terraform, Skaffold, Docker, Kubernetes, Git, Linux (Debian, Ubuntu).
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Professional Experience

Google

Zurich, Switzerland & Dublin, Ireland · May 2012 – Present

Staff Developer Advocate (L6) – Google Cloud (2021 – Present | Zurich)

- Technical authority for Site Reliability Engineering (SRE), Generative & Agentic AI, Developer Experience (DevX), and Cloud Operations across EMEA and globally.
- **Agentic AI & Autonomous SRE Systems:** Designed and demonstrated autonomous skill-based SRE agents combining Gemini multimodal reasoning, Model Context Protocol (MCP), and Google ADK to automate metric anomaly/regression detection, live Kubernetes cluster diagnostics, and incident post-mortem drafting. Authored open-source agentic frameworks ([antigravity-ruby-sdk](#) with Policy Engine DSL, [sre-extension](#)).
- **“The Art of SLOs” Global Program:** Global co-owner and lead of Google’s primary SRE enablement curriculum. Authored the official video course hosted on [sre.google \(YouTube\)](#), founded the international trainer network, and delivered multi-day workshops in Japan, UK, Germany, Spain, and Italy.
- **Product Influence & DevX:** Defined user requirements and reference architectures for Google Cloud Deploy, Cloud Build, and Skaffold; authored official canary deployment guides ([Video](#) · [GitHub](#)) and conducted systematic developer friction logs.
- **International Keynote Speaker:** Featured speaker at major conferences including Google Cloud Next Las Vegas, George UX Conf Vienna, SRE Day Amsterdam, DevSecOps Day Bologna, CloudConf Turin, Codemotion Milan, and Euruko.

Strategic Customer Engineer (SCE) / TAM Lead – Google Cloud PSO (2015 – 2021 | Zurich)

“Forward Deployed Engineers ante-litteram” - Lead cloud architect and trusted advisor for Google Cloud’s largest strategic enterprise customers in EMEA. - **DACH SCE Team Lead (2018–2019):** Scoped strategic engagements, managed team allocation, and mentored SCEs across Germany, Switzerland, and Poland. - **Enterprise Customer Architectures:** - *Lufthansa:* Led Infrastructure and Operations Research workstreams uniting High-Performance Computing (HPC) infrastructure with petabyte-scale analytics. Praised by customer leadership as one of their most impactful technical contributors. - *Deutsche Bank:* Led strategic POCs for enterprise collaboration and cloud infrastructure presented to executive stakeholders. - *SAP:* Technical governance lead across multiple delivery streams, resolving complex hybrid-cloud networking and interconnect

challenges. - *Iponweb*: Architected multi-year zero-downtime migration of ultra-high-throughput ad-tech platforms from AWS to Google Compute Engine. - *Wix*: Technical advisor for enterprise adoption of Google Cloud DNS, ensuring multi-region resilience. - **Internal Data Innovation & Tooling**: Conceived and built automated telemetry pipelines and reporting systems supporting 1,000+ engineers globally. Established Centers of Excellence across EMEA and APAC.

Enterprise Technical Solutions Engineer (TSE) – Google Cloud (*May 2012 – May 2015* | *Dublin & Zurich*)

- Provided tier-3 systems support and escalation management during the early launch of Google Compute Engine (GCE), Google App Engine, and Cloud Storage.
 - Interfaced directly with GCE engineering and PM teams in Seattle and Mountain View to drive platform features and supportability.
 - Created and managed primary/quaternary pager rotations for Cloud Support and TAM teams. Built provisioning tools in Python and Bash.
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Hochschule Luzern (HSLU) – Lucerne University of Applied Sciences and Arts

Rotkreuz / Lucerne, Switzerland · *May 2023 – Present*

University Lecturer – Postgraduate CAS Programs in Cloud Computing - External university lecturer at the Lucerne School of Information Technology (HSLU Informatik, Rotkreuz campus), teaching across **two postgraduate Certificate of Advanced Studies (CAS) programs**: - **CAS Cloud Architecture** - **CAS Cloud and Platform Manager (CAS CPM)**. (across **7 consecutive cohorts: CAS CPM 7 through CAS CPM 13**) - Teaches full-day intensive modules on **Google Cloud Platform (GCP)** foundations, enterprise landing zones, IAM/networking, Cloud Run/GKE, Gemini AI workshops, and Site Reliability Engineering (SRE) practices to IT leaders, cloud architects, and platform engineers.

Dell Inc.

Dublin, Ireland · *Jun 2011 – May 2012*

Cloud Senior Developer (DevOps / Cloud Architecture) - Architected and deployed bare-metal cloud infrastructure using Puppet, Chef, Ganeti, KVM, Xen, and VMware ESXi. - Core contributor to *Crowbar*, Dell's open-source automated cloud deployment framework. - Built, maintained, and fully puppetized the Linux development server fleet (Git, DNS, OpenLDAP, Wiki, Samba, Swift, Nova).

HEAnet (Ireland's National Education and Research Network)

Dublin, Ireland · *Feb 2009 – Apr 2011*

Network Systems Software Developer & Sysadmin - Designed, developed, and maintained critical network services and automation platforms in Ruby on Rails, Perl, Python, and Bash. - Applied Agile/BDD methodologies, RESTful APIs, and deep integration of Request Tracker (RT) ticketing internals with Rails applications. -

Administered high-availability Ubuntu/Debian server fleet: Apache, Nagios (custom NRPE plugins), Munin, MRTG, OpenLDAP, Exim, heartbeat, and MySQL master-slave replication. Participated in 24/7 NOC on-call rotation.

Lake Communications

Dublin, Ireland · Oct 2008 – Feb 2009

Senior Software Developer - Embedded firmware development, VoIP routing, and network configuration for PBX telephone systems on MIPS hardware running BusyBox and Linux. Customized Asterisk PBX in C and shell scripting.

Laboratori Guglielmo Marconi

Bologna, Italy · Sep 2003 – Oct 2008

Senior Network & Systems Engineer - Designed and managed enterprise network infrastructures and Linux server farms for public administration and healthcare organizations (5,000+ users). - Administered Linux systems (Debian, Slackware), RDBMS optimization (PostgreSQL, MySQL), OpenLDAP groupware, and Cisco/HP networking. - Perimeter security: iptables firewalling, VPN concentrators, and security audits with Snort IDS. - Security Expert and Project Manager for European Union railway research initiatives (*Euromain* and *Integrail*). 1-year NOC shift rota.

Università di Bologna

Bologna, Italy · 2002 – 2003

Academic Researcher & Teaching Assistant - Assisted Prof. Massimo Ferri in teaching *Vision Mathematics* in the Master in Mathematics for Applications program. - Published post-graduate research in computer vision at ARCES: “*An adaptive approach to Shadow Removal for the detection of vehicles in Video Surveillance Systems and an 8-connectivity labeling algorithm*”.

Education & Academic Qualifications

- **Laurea Quinquennale in Ingegneria Informatica (5-Year Master's Degree in Computer Engineering)**
Università degli Studi di Bologna, Italy (1995 – Mar 2002) · Final Grade: **99/100**
Thesis in Artificial Intelligence and Computer Vision: “*Descriptors and metrics for tracking objects in image sequences for video surveillance applications*”.
- **Post-Graduate University Master in Information Security (1,500 hours)**
Università di Bologna, Italy (Jan 2003 – Sep 2003). Advanced network security, intrusion detection, cryptography, and enterprise policies.
- **State Professional Engineering Qualification (Abilitazione all'Esercizio della Professione di Ingegnere)** (Nov 2002).
- **High School Diploma (Maturità Scientifica)** · *Liceo Scientifico Don Minzoni, Argenta (FE), Italy* (1990 – 1995) · Grade: **60/60**.

- **Scuola Normale Superiore di Pisa** (Sep 1994) · Selected for the XVI University Orientation Course in Cortona (reserved for the top 150 high school students in Italy).
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Certifications

- **Google Cloud Certified**: Professional Cloud DevOps Engineer (2020)
 - **Google Cloud Certified**: Professional Cloud Architect (2017, 2020)
 - **Google Cloud Certified**: Professional Data Engineer (2017)
 - **Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA)**: CCNA 4 WAN Technologies (2003)
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Selected Speaking, Keynotes & Video Recordings

- **Google Cloud Next Las Vegas 2024**: “Goodbye, Deployment Headaches: Cloud Deploy and Vertex AI Unite” (Session DEV302 · 🎥 [YouTube Video](#) · 📄 [PDF Slides](#))
 - **George UX Conf Vienna 2023**: “Reimagining Customer Services with GenAI and Multi-Modal Interaction” (~1,800 attendees in room & remote · 🎥 [YouTube Video](#))
 - **DevSecOps Day Bologna 2024 (Keynote)**: “Where SRE Can Go Wrong / Dove l’SRE può andare storto” (🎥 [YouTube Video](#) · 🌐 [Speaker Page](#))
 - **SRE Day Amsterdam 2024 (Keynote)**: “SRE Gone Wrong: Top 7 Errors (and How to Avoid Them)” (🌐 [Keynote Page](#) · 🎥 [Related GDG Video](#))
 - **RubyDay Verona 2024**: “News Crawler via LangChain.RB and Gemini APIs” (🎥 [YouTube Video](#) · 🌐 [Session Page](#))
 - **Rubycon Italy 2026**: Co-organizer & Master of Ceremonies (🎥 [Welcome Video](#) · 🌐 [rubycon.it](#))
 - **Codemotion Milan 2026**: “Stop Grepping, Start Reasoning: Skill-Based Agentic SRE 🚀” (🌐 [Article & Demo](#))
 - **CloudConf Turin 2025 & 2024**: “SRE Gone Wrong: Top 7 Errors” (2025) · “Software Development with Google” (2024)
 - **Euruko Sarajevo 2024**: “Workshop: Bring your Ruby app in the Cloud” (🌐 [Speaker Page](#))
 - **The Art of SLOs Official Curriculum**: Google Cloud Video Course (🎥 [YouTube Video](#) · 🌐 [sre.google](#))
 - **Cloud Deploy Canary Deployment Blueprint**: Multi-environment CI/CD Demo (🎥 [YouTube Video](#) · 📄 [GitHub Repo](#))
 - **GDG Cloud**: “Introduction to SRE & Deploying Landing Zone via Fabric FAST” (🎥 [YouTube Video](#))
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Spoken Languages

- **Italian**: Native (C2)
- **English**: Fluent / Full Professional (C1/C2)
- **Brazilian Portuguese**: Conversational / Good (B2)
- **French**: Intermediate (B1)
- **German**: Elementary / Working knowledge (A2/B1)

Personal Achievements & Interests

- **Endurance Sports:** Completed **2 full Ironman triathlons** (3.8 km swim, 180 km bike, 42.2 km run).
- **Music:** Classical and modern pianist ( [YouTube performance](#)).
- **Mathematics & Community:** Lifelong passion for mathematics and STEM education ([Math in pills YouTube playlist](#)). Created an early student web portal (*goliardia.it*) in 2002 that grew to 2,000+ active members.